

Trump Officials Decry Protests and Demand Protection for ICE Agents

As court battles loom over National Guard deployments, the administration demanded that Portland, Ore., do more to secure an immigration facility, and President Trump said the Illinois governor and Chicago mayor should be “in jail.”

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Anna Griffin, Mitch Smith, Eric Schmitt and Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs Reporting from Portland, Ore., Chicago and Washington



Here is the latest.

Federal officials increased their attacks Wednesday on city and state leaders in places where President Trump wants to deploy National Guard troops, accusing them of failing to support federal agents and demanding more security at federal facilities. The heated rhetoric included comments from Mr. Trump suggesting three Democratic officials should be jailed.

Administration officials used appearances on conservative news outlets and at the White House to amp up descriptions of violence and denounce leaders and demonstrators in Chicago and Portland, Ore. Local officials have blamed aggressive tactics by Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents and unprovoked attacks on protesters for causing any unrest.

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Oct. 9, 2025, 12:37 a.m. ET
Mitch Smith Reporting from Chicago



A spokesperson for U.S. Northern Command said Texas National Guard troops started “actively protecting federal personnel and property” in the Chicago area on Wednesday

evening. There was no visible military presence tonight outside a complex of downtown federal buildings or outside the ICE facility in suburban Broadview, where protesters have often gathered.



Oct. 8, 2025, 8:37 p.m. ET
Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs Reporting from Chicago



The anti-Trump protest in downtown Chicago has grown to roughly 1,000 people, and they are marching in the shadow of the Trump Tower. Things have been entirely peaceful here so far, with the only clash of any kind coming when a small group began arguing with a lone counterprotester who was speaking into a microphone about opposing illegal immigration. Chicago Police officers got between the groups and the situation cooled off.

By Daniel Wood



Chicago area: 500 troops

About 200 Texas troops are expected to begin operations soon, with some 300 federalized Illinois troops to follow.



Portland, Ore.: None

A federal judge temporarily blocked deployment of hundreds of California and



Oregon troops staged near the city.



Washington: 2,400

Deployed in August in what the administration called a crime-fighting push.



Los Angeles: 100

Peaked at 4,700 in June. Trump is appealing a ruling that the deployment was illegal.



Oct. 8, 2025, 7:47 p.m. ET

Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs Reporting from Chicago



Several hundred anti-Trump protesters are beginning to march along Michigan Avenue in downtown Chicago. A group of people on a double-decker tour bus just shouted in support as they rolled by, eliciting cheers from the protesters.



Oct. 8, 2025, 7:08 p.m. ET

Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs Reporting from Chicago



More people are joining a demonstration that is just getting going in downtown Chicago, protesting the Trump administration and its National Guard and immigration operations.

Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs/The New York Times



Oct. 8, 2025, 7:07 p.m. ET

Robert Chiarito Reporting from Broadview, Ill.



A group of four veterans protested outside the ICE facility in Broadview, Ill. Although their presence was small, they said they hoped it would give the protest movement more credibility among the general public. Aidan Price, a 34-year-old former Marine who teaches civics and history in a Chicago public high school, said he has always believed in American exceptionalism, but the current state of things has him concerned. “I thought I was the most patriotic guy around,” he said, adding, “But when I see the things that are happening, it’s just scary.”

Jamie Kelter Davis for The New York Times



Oct. 8, 2025, 7:05 p.m. ET

Mitch Smith Reporting from Chicago



Several Republican attorneys general told a judge that President Trump was within his authority to send troops to Illinois, noting that protesters had clashed with federal agents. The “deployment of a small number of National Guard members to defend against this lawlessness is responsible, constitutional and authorized by statute,” their brief said.



Oct. 8, 2025, 6:34 p.m. ET

Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs Reporting from Chicago



Two helicopters are hovering above the Congress Plaza Garden in downtown Chicago, a plaza where roughly 200 people have gathered to protest the Trump administration’s deployment of National Guard troops and immigration officers to Chicago. At least a dozen city police officers, some on bicycles, have gathered nearby.

**Oct. 8, 2025, 6:19 p.m. ET**

Pooja Salhotra



In a court filing in the National Guard case in Illinois, a group of former secretaries, admirals and generals of the U.S. Army and Navy told the judge that domestic deployments of the Guard are inherently risky. They urged the judge to consider such risks as “the politicization of the military.”

**Oct. 8, 2025, 5:54 p.m. ET**

J. David Goodman Reporting from Houston



Texas’ blue-state deployments are shredding relations between governors.

Members of the Texas National Guard at the U.S. Army Reserve Training Center in Elwood, Ill., a far southwest suburb of Chicago, on Tuesday. Jamie Kelter Davis for The New York Times

The deployment of Texas National Guard troops to Illinois at the behest of President Trump has divided the nation's governors, severing the bonds between state leaders who have long portrayed themselves as above the partisan fray.

The Illinois governor, JB Pritzker, along with Gov. Gavin Newsom of California, both Democrats, have threatened to leave the once-chummy National Governors Association, a group formed more than 100 years ago and dedicated to finding areas of bipartisan agreement even in fractious political times.

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Oct. 8, 2025, 5:39 p.m. ET

Mattathias Schwartz Reporting on federal courts



A federal judge imposed new limits on ICE's operations in Chicago.

Federal law enforcement officers outside an immigration processing center in the Chicago suburb of Broadview, Ill., last week. The ruling suggests that another judge is skeptical about the Trump administration's willingness to adhere to legal requirements as it ratchets up mass deportations. Jamie Kelter Davis for The New York Times

A federal judge in Chicago has imposed new limitations on the ability of Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers to make arrests without warrants, siding with plaintiffs in

a long-running class-action lawsuit against ICE.

The ruling, which stems from a consent decree struck by the Biden administration in 2022, is unrelated to the pending legal challenges to President Trump's deployment of the National Guard troops in Chicago and Portland, Ore. But it signals that another judge is skeptical about the Trump administration's willingness to adhere to legal requirements as the president ratchets up his mass deportations.

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Oct. 8, 2025, 5:37 p.m. ET
Eric Schmitt



About two dozen Texas National Guard soldiers are expected to begin public operations in the Chicago area tonight, according to a U.S. military official who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss operational matters. It will be the Guard's first mission in the region since members arrived yesterday at a training facility about an hour's drive southwest of downtown. The troops are authorized only to protect federal agents and facilities.



Oct. 8, 2025, 5:22 p.m. ET
Mitch Smith Reporting from Chicago



A bipartisan group of former governors, including at least five who served as Republicans, told a federal judge that they opposed the president's mobilization of National Guard troops in Illinois. They said the move "threatens to upset the delicate balance of state and federal authority that underlies our constitutional order." The judge is holding a hearing in the case tomorrow.



Oct. 8, 2025, 5:15 p.m. ET
Pooja Salhotra



Adding to the state and federal tension, Gov. JB Pritzker of Illinois has ordered an investigation of a recent ICE raid on a Chicago apartment complex, after reports that U.S. citizens and children were among those detained. The agency's acting director, Todd Lyons, asserted in a Newsmax interview that the building had been taken over by gang members, and said U.S. citizens would only have been arrested if they were attacking

officers.



Oct. 8, 2025, 4:58 p.m. ET

Chris Cameron Reporting from Washington



At the White House, President Trump described Portland protesters as “insurrectionists” and “terrible people.” Trump said on Monday that he would consider invoking the Insurrection Act — an 1807 law that grants the president emergency powers to deploy troops on U.S. soil — as a way to get around court orders and local opposition to his effort to deploy National Guard troops in American cities.

Anna Rose Layden for The New York Times



Oct. 8, 2025, 4:39 p.m. ET

Anna Griffin Reporting from Portland, Ore.



Judges on a federal appeals court have ruled that Oregon National Guard members can stay under federal control until a broader legal ruling is issued, though the troops cannot yet enter Portland. Officials there have sued to stop President Trump from using military units to protect federal agents and facilities. Judges are scheduled to hear oral arguments on Thursday.

**Oct. 8, 2025, 4:14 p.m. ET**

Ernesto Londoño Midwest news reporter



A Chicago federal grand jury deals the latest setback to Trump's immigration enforcement efforts.

Demonstrators faced off with law enforcement near an ICE facility in Broadview, Ill., west of downtown Chicago, on Friday. Jamie Kelter Davis for The New York Times

A federal grand jury has elected not to indict two individuals who were charged with assaulting federal law enforcement officers during a protest outside a suburban Chicago immigration facility last month.

The grand jury's rejection of felony charges, disclosed in federal court in Chicago on Wednesday, represented a new setback in the Trump administration's crackdown on illegal immigration in cities around the country. It was the latest instance in which federal prosecutors failed to convince a panel of citizens that there was probable cause that a crime had been committed.

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**Oct. 8, 2025, 4:03 p.m. ET**

Chris Cameron Reporting from Washington



Throughout this White House event on left-wing activism, President Trump and his subordinates have portrayed protesters in Portland and Chicago, as well as other political opponents, as a threat to the United States on par with foreign gangs, drug cartels and terrorists.

**Oct. 8, 2025, 3:46 p.m. ET**

Luke Broadwater Reporting from the White House



In an event at the White House, President Trump suggested that Senator Richard Blumenthal, Democrat of Connecticut, should be jailed for intense questioning of Attorney General Pam Bondi during an oversight hearing that included discussion of National Guard deployments. Trump compared Blumenthal to George Santos, the disgraced former congressman convicted of fraud. “He looks at people like Pam, and he starts criticizing her, and she’s a patriot,” Trump said of Blumenthal.

Kenny Holston/The New York Times

**Oct. 8, 2025, 3:41 p.m. ET**

Luke Broadwater Reporting from the White House



At the White House, President Trump is hosting an event on the topic of antifa, a loosely defined left-wing antifascist movement that he recently designated a domestic terrorist organization. Trump says the federal government will punish any left-wing protesters who threaten law enforcement, which his administration claims has been happening in Chicago and Portland, Ore. “That includes the people that fund them,” he says.



Oct. 8, 2025, 3:19 p.m. ET

Anna Griffin Reporting from Portland, Ore.



How did Noem’s meetings with elected leaders in Portland go? Accounts have varied, but demands were clear.

Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem on the roof of an ICE detention center in Portland, Ore., on Tuesday. With her during the visit were federal workers and several conservative influencers. Jordan Gale for The New York Times

Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem and state and city leaders who met with her in Portland, Ore., on Tuesday have offered sharply differing accounts of their conversations and perceptions of the situation at an Immigration and Customs Enforcement building that has been the focus of protests.

In Ms. Noem’s telling, she presented those leaders with a clear choice on the protests at the ICE building, in South Portland: Do more to protect federal officers or face an influx of federal forces.

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Oct. 8, 2025, 3:13 p.m. ET
Anna Griffin Reporting from Portland, Ore.



The police have continued to cordon off a one-block radius around the ICE building in Portland, Ore., and protesters who have been camping near the building for months say they have been told that the area will remain closed to the public for at least a week.

Jordan Gale for The New York Times



Oct. 8, 2025, 3:13 p.m. ET
Jesus Jiménez Reporting from Chicago



Representative Robin Kelly, whose district includes part of Chicago, said on Wednesday that she had not yet received reports of National Guard troops on the ground in the downtown area of the city. She criticized President Trump for saying Gov. JB Pritzker of

Illinois and Mayor Brandon Johnson should be in jail. “I think the president wants the violence, wants the chaos,” she said.



Oct. 8, 2025, 1:56 p.m. ET

Mattathias Schwartz Reporting on federal courts



President Trump’s decisions to deploy the National Guard cannot be questioned by federal judges, the nonprofit group America First Legal argued in a court filing on Tuesday, in support of the administration’s appeal to send troops to Portland, Ore. The group, founded by Stephen Miller, cited an 1827 Supreme Court case that found the president “exclusively” held “the authority to decide” when to use statutory powers to call up the Guard.



Oct. 8, 2025, 1:12 p.m. ET

Anna Griffin Reporting from Portland, Ore.



Kristi Noem, the Homeland Security secretary, told Fox News on Tuesday evening that she made clear demands to leaders in Portland, Ore., about changes she wanted to see at the ICE building there, including adding more security and a larger buffer zone for officers. Noem said she told the mayor that if he did not comply, she would send “four times the amount of federal officers.”

Mathieu Lewis-Rolland/Getty Images

**Oct. 8, 2025, 12:32 p.m. ET**

Mitch Smith Reporting from Chicago



Lawyers for Cook County, Ill., which includes Chicago, have filed a court brief supporting efforts to block the deployment of National Guard troops, saying President Trump's action would "intrude on state and local sovereignty" and increase public fear. A hearing in that case is scheduled for tomorrow.

**Oct. 8, 2025, 10:46 a.m. ET**

Luke Broadwater Reporting from the White House



NEWS ANALYSIS

Trump says Chicago's mayor and Illinois's governor should be jailed.

President Trump has repeatedly attacked Gov. JB Pritzker of Illinois and Mayor Brandon Johnson of Chicago, who have denounced the administration's National Guard deployment to the Chicago area. Scott Olson/Getty Images

In the span of a few hours on Wednesday, President Trump threatened to jail the

Democratic governor of Illinois and the mayor of Chicago; suggested a Democratic senator should be punished for questioning his administration; described left-wing protesters in Portland as “insurrectionists”; and endorsed out-of-state troops descending on Democratic-run cities.

Increasingly, Mr. Trump has made clear what he views as the top threat against America: what he calls the “enemy from within.” And his definition of that enemy is expanding, particularly as he looks to deploy the military on the streets of American cities.

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Oct. 8, 2025, 10:36 a.m. ET
Robert Chiarito Reporting from Broadview, Ill.



Near the ICE facility in Broadview, Ill., there were a few protesters and several journalists this morning, but no sign of the National Guard. A few Cook County Sheriff’s officers and Illinois State Police officers were present, mostly sitting inside their parked vehicles on what so far has been an uneventful morning.

